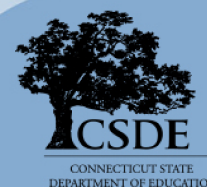


DISTRICT PROFILE AND PERFORMANCE REPORT FOR SCHOOL YEAR 2020–21



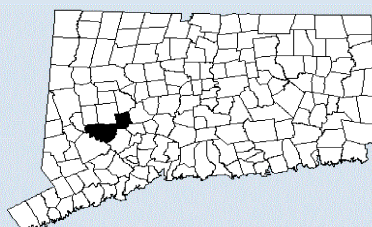
Regional School District 15

Mr. Joshua Smith, Superintendent • 203-758-8259 • <http://www.region15.org>

District Information

Grade Range	PK-12
Number of Schools/Programs	8
Enrollment	3,513
Per Pupil Expenditures ¹	\$19,521
Total Expenditures ¹	\$73,107,395

¹ Expenditure data reflect the 2019-20 school year.



Community Information

[AdvanceCT Town Profiles](#) provide summary demographic and economic information for Connecticut's municipalities

Contents

Students.....	1
Educators.....	2
Instruction and Resources.....	2
Performance and Accountability.....	4
Narratives.....	7

Notes

Unless otherwise noted, all data are for 2020-21 and include all grades offered by the district.

In most tables, data are displayed only for the three major race/ethnicity categories. For additional race/ethnicity categories, please visit <https://edsight.ct.gov>

State totals are not displayed as they are not comparable to district totals.

Special Education tables reflect only students for whom the district is fiscally responsible.

* When an asterisk is displayed, data have been suppressed to safeguard student confidentiality, or to ensure that statistics based on a very small sample size are not interpreted as equally representative as those based on a sufficiently larger sample size.

N/A is displayed when a category is not applicable for a district or school.

Students

October 1, 2020 Enrollment²

	Count	District Percent of Total (%)	State Percent of Total (%)
Female	1,694	48.2	48.4
Male	1,819	51.8	51.5
American Indian or Alaska Native	*	*	0.3
Asian	179	5.1	5.2
Black or African American	71	2.0	12.7
Hispanic or Latino of any race	230	6.5	27.8
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	*	*	0.1
Two or More Races	102	2.9	4.0
White	2,922	83.2	49.9
English Learners	46	1.3	8.3
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	488	13.9	42.7
Students with Disabilities ³	645	18.4	16.3

NOTE: To protect student privacy, gender counts are suppressed (*) when fewer than 6 students enrolled in the district identify as non-binary.

² This table represents students in grades PK-12 reported by the district in the Public School Information System (i.e., PSIS Reporting District).

³ Students in this category are students with an individualized education program (IEP) only. This category does not include students with Section 504 plans or services plans.

Chronic Absenteeism and Suspension/Expulsion

	Chronic Absenteeism ⁴		Suspension/Expulsion ⁵	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	57	3.4	*	*
Male	72	4.0	*	*
Black or African American	10	12.5	0	0.0
Hispanic or Latino of any race	16	7.0	*	*
White	98	3.4	27	0.9
English Learners	*	*	0	0.0
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	48	10.8	11	2.1
Students with Disabilities	58	9.6	16	2.2
District	129	3.7	36	1.0
State		19.0		1.4

Number of students in 2019-20 qualified as truant under state statute: 55

Number of school-based arrests: 0

NOTE: In the 2020-21 school year, students attended school in-person to varying degrees; some learned fully/mostly remotely for the entire school year. Chronic absenteeism calculations are based only on in-person school days.

⁴ A student is chronically absent if they miss ten percent or greater of the total number of days enrolled in the school year for any reason. Pre-Kindergarten students are excluded from this calculation.

⁵ This column displays the count and percentage of students who receive at least one in-school suspension, out-of-school suspension or expulsion.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Regional School District 15

Educators

Full-Time Equivalent (FTE)¹ Staff

	FTE
General Education	
Teachers and Instructors	232.1
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	37.0
Special Education	
Teachers and Instructors	45.5
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	103.0
Administrators, Coordinators and Department Chairs	
District Central Office	6.0
School Level	16.0
Library/Media	
Specialists (Certified)	8.0
Support Staff	4.0
Instructional Specialists Who Support Teachers	21.5
Counselors, Social Workers and School Psychologists	23.0
School Nurses	10.8
Other Staff Providing Non-Instructional Services/Support	165.5

¹ In the full-time equivalent count, staff members working part-time in the school are counted as a fraction of full-time. For example, a teacher who works half-time in a school contributes 0.50 to the school's staff count.

Educators by Race/Ethnicity

	Count	District Percent of Total (%)	State Percent of Total (%)
American Indian or Alaska Native	0	0.0	0.1
Asian	2	0.6	1.3
Black or African American	2	0.6	4.1
Hispanic or Latino of any race	2	0.6	4.3
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	0.0	0.1
Two or More Races	0	0.0	0.1
White	348	98.3	89.9

Classroom Teacher Attendance: 2019-20

	District	State
Average Number of FTE Days Absent Due to Illness or Personal Time	8.8	7.3

Instruction and Resources

11th and 12th Graders Enrolled in College-and-Career-Readiness Courses during High School²

	11th		12th	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Black or African American	*	*	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	21	72.4	7	*
White	147	60.0	215	84.0
English Learners	*	*	0	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	30	58.8	19	61.3
Students with Disabilities	29	47.5	32	64.0
District	194	62.6	246	82.6
State		75.9		85.6

² College-and-Career-Readiness Courses include Advanced Placement®(AP), International Baccalaureate®(IB), Career and Technical Education(CTE), workplace experience and dual enrollment courses.

Students with Disabilities Who Spend 79.1 to 100 Percent of Time with Nondisabled Peers³

	Count	Rate (%)
Autism	43	45.7
Emotional Disturbance	23	63.9
Intellectual Disability	*	*
Learning Disability	179	76.2
Other Health Impairment	112	79.4
Other Disabilities	*	*
Speech/Language Impairment	41	91.1
District	410	70.0
State		67.9

³ This table represents students ages 6-21 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Regional School District 15

Students with Disabilities by Primary Disability¹

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Autism	95	2.7	2.1
Emotional Disturbance	37	1.1	1.1
Intellectual Disability	9	0.3	0.5
Learning Disability	237	6.7	5.8
Other Health Impairment	141	4.0	3.3
Other Disabilities	42	1.2	1.2
Speech/Language Impairment	49	1.4	1.9
All Disabilities	610	17.3	15.9

¹ This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Students with Disabilities Placed Outside of the District²

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Public Schools in Other Districts	17	2.8	8.3
Private Schools or Other Settings	30	4.9	4.8

² This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Overall Expenditures³: 2019-20

	Total (\$)	Per Pupil	
		District (\$)	State (\$)
Instruction	\$43,111,819	\$11,512	\$11,205
Support services - students	\$6,216,608	\$1,705	\$1,346
Support services - instruction	\$1,681,049	\$461	\$698
Support services - general administration	\$4,174,271	\$1,145	\$464
Support services - school based administration	\$4,664,942	\$1,279	\$1,037
Central and other support services	\$663,358	\$182	\$691
Operation and maintenance of plant	\$6,681,506	\$1,833	\$1,692
Student transportation services	\$4,805,931	\$1,290	\$1,159
Food services	\$245,000	\$67	\$21
Enterprise operations	\$862,911	\$237	\$151
Total	\$73,107,395	\$19,521	\$17,838

³ Expenditures may be supported by local tax revenues, state grants, federal grants, municipal in-kind services, tuition and other sources.

Special Education Expenditures: 2019-20

	District		State
	Total (\$)	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Teacher Salaries	\$6,229,925	30.3	29.6
Instructional Aide Salaries	\$2,721,620	13.2	11.1
Other Salaries	\$1,028,364	5.0	9.5
Employee Benefits	\$2,660,889	12.9	13.5
Purchased Services Other Than Transportation	\$814,966	4.0	5.4
Special Education Tuition	\$4,905,315	23.9	22.5
Supplies	\$103,079	0.5	0.5
Property Services	\$123,062	0.6	0.3
Purchased Services For Transportation	\$1,951,211	9.5	7.2
Equipment	\$13,399	0.1	0.2
All Other Expenditures	\$795	0.0	0.1
Total	\$20,552,624	100.0	100.0
Percent of Total Expenditures Used for Special Education		28.1	25.1

Expenditures by Revenue Source⁴: 2019-20

	Percent of Total (%) Excluding School Construction
Local	88.3
State	9.9
Federal	1.5
Tuition & Other	0.2

⁴ Revenue sources do not include state-funded Teachers' Retirement Board contributions, Connecticut Technical Education and Career System (CTECS) operations, CSDE-budgeted costs for salaries and leadership activities and other state-funded school districts (e.g., Dept. of Children and Families and Dept. of Correction).

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Regional School District 15

Performance and Accountability

District Performance Index (DPI)

A District Performance Index (DPI) is the average performance of students in a subject area (i.e., ELA, Mathematics or Science) on the state summative assessments. The DPI ranges from 0-100. A DPI is reported for all students tested in a district and for students in each individual student group. Connecticut's ultimate target for a DPI is 75.

NOTE: As a result of ongoing challenges related to the novel Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19), Connecticut's request for a waiver from implementing district/school accountability for the 2020-21 school year was approved. Therefore, no table is shown here. For additional information, please view Connecticut's waiver response at: <https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Digest/2020-21/CommissionerMemoAccountabilityWaiver.pdf>

National Assessment of Educational Progress (NAEP): Percent At or Above Proficient¹

READING	NAEP 2019		NAEP 2013
	Grade 4	Grade 8	Grade 12
Connecticut	40	41	50
National Public	34	32	36
MATH	Grade 4	Grade 8	Grade 12
Connecticut	45	39	32
National Public	40	33	25

¹ NAEP is often called the "Nation's Report Card." It is sponsored by the U.S. Department of Education. This table compares Connecticut's performance to that of national public school students. Performance standards for state assessments and NAEP are set independently. Therefore, one should not expect performance results to be the same across Smarter Balanced and NAEP. Instead, NAEP results are meant to complement other state assessment data. To view performance on NAEP by student group, at https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Student-Assessment/NAEP/report-card_NAEP-2019.pdf

Physical Fitness Tests: Students Reaching Health Standard

NOTE: As a result of ongoing challenges related to the novel Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19), Connecticut's request for a waiver from implementing district/school accountability for the 2020-21 school year was approved. Therefore, no table is shown here. For additional information, please view Connecticut's waiver response at: <https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Digest/2020-21/CommissionerMemoAccountabilityWaiver.pdf>

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Regional School District 15

Cohort Graduation: Four-Year¹

	2019-20	
	Cohort Count ²	Rate (%)
Black or African American	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	16	*
English Learners	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	59	88.1
Students with Disabilities	54	79.6
District	325	96.3
State		88.8

¹ The four-year cohort graduation rate represents the percentage of first-time 9th graders who earn a standard high school diploma within four years.

² Cohort count includes all students in the cohort as of the end of the 2019-20 school year.

11th and 12th Graders Meeting Benchmark on at Least One College Readiness Exam³

	Participation ⁴	Meeting Benchmark	
	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	94.1	189	62.0
Male	88.4	155	51.2
Black or African American	*	*	*
Hispanic or Latino	92.9	20	47.6
White	90.8	276	55.1
English Learners	*	0	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	85.4	32	39.0
Students with Disabilities	78.4	10	9.0
District	91.3	344	56.6
State	85.0		36.0

³ College readiness exams and benchmark scores are as follows:

- SAT® - meets benchmark score on SAT, Revised SAT or Connecticut School Day SAT
- ACT® - meets benchmark score on 3 of 4 exams (benchmark score varies by subject)
- AP® - 3 or higher on any one AP® exam
- IB® - 4 or higher on any one IB® exam

⁴ Participation Rate equals the number of test-takers in 11th and 12th grade divided by the number of students enrolled in those grades, as a percentage.

Sources:

SAT® and AP® statistics derived from data provided by the College Board.

Copyright © 2021 The College Board. www.collegeboard.org

ACT® statistics derived from data provided by ACT, Inc.

Copyright © 2021 ACT, Inc. www.act.org

IB® statistics derived from data provided by the International Baccalaureate Organization.

Copyright © International Baccalaureate Organization 2021

* The data are suppressed to ensure confidentiality.

College Entrance and Persistence

	Class of 2020	Class of 2019
	Entrance ³	Persistence ⁴
	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Female	93.9	96.8
Male	75.1	84.6
Black or African American	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	*	*
White	83.6	91.3
English Learners	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	61.1	78.8
Students with Disabilities	62.2	66.7
District	83.9	90.6
State	67.4	84.9

³ College entrance refers to the percent of high school graduates from the year who enrolled in college any time during the first year after high school.

⁴ College persistence refers to the percent of students who enrolled in college the first year after high school and returned for a second year (Freshman to Sophomore persistence).

Source: National Student Clearinghouse

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Regional School District 15

Next Generation Accountability Results

Connecticut's Next Generation Accountability System is a broad set of 12 indicators that help tell the story of how well a district/school is preparing its students for success in college, careers, and life. It moves beyond test scores and graduation rates to provide a more holistic, multifactor perspective of district and school performance.

NOTE: As a result of ongoing challenges related to the novel Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19), Connecticut's request for a waiver from implementing district/school accountability for the 2020-21 school year was approved. Therefore, a modified table is shown below. All indicators that were not calculated for the 2020-21 school year (including overall Accountability Index) have been excluded and columns that referenced points have also been removed to avoid confusion. For additional information, please view Connecticut's waiver response at: <https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Digest/2020-21/CommissionerMemoAccountabilityWaiver.pdf>

Indicator		Index/Rate	Target	State Average Index/Rate
Chronic Absenteeism	All Students	3.7%	<=5%	19.0%
	High Needs Students	8.8%	<=5%	30.2%
Preparation for CCR	% Taking Courses	72.4%	75%	80.6%
	% Passing Exams	56.6%	75%	36.0%
On-track to High School Graduation		93.0%	94%	84.5%
4-year Graduation All Students (2020 Cohort)		96.3%	94%	88.8%
6-year Graduation - High Needs Students (2018 Cohort)		92.1%	94%	85.2%
Postsecondary Entrance (Class of 2020)		83.9%	75%	67.4%
Arts Access		56.7%	60%	50.7%

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in the student group or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.

Gap Indicators	Non-High Needs Rate ¹	High Needs Rate	Size of Gap	State Gap Mean +1 Stdev ²	Is Gap an Outlier? ²
Graduation Rate Gap	94.0%	92.1%	1.9%	9.8%	N

¹ If the Non-High Needs Rate exceeds the ultimate target (75 for Performance Index and 94% for graduation rate), the ultimate target is used for gap calculations.

² If the size of the gap exceeds the state mean gap plus one standard deviation, the gap is an outlier.

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in at least one of the student groups used to calculate the gap measure or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.

Connecticut's State Identified Measurable Result (SIMR) for Children with Disabilities

Increase the reading performance of all 3rd grade students with disabilities statewide, as measured by Connecticut's English Language Arts (ELA) Performance Index.

NOTE: As a result of ongoing challenges related to the novel Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19), Connecticut's request for a waiver from implementing district/school accountability for the 2020-21 school year was approved. Therefore, no SIMR data are available. For additional information, please view Connecticut's waiver response at: <https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Digest/2020-21/CommissionerMemoAccountabilityWaiver.pdf>

Supporting Resources:

Two-page FAQ at http://edsight.ct.gov/relatedreports/nextgenFAQ_revisedDec2018.pdf

Detailed Presentation at https://edsight.ct.gov/relatedreports/Next%20Generation%20Accountability%20System_Detailed%20Presentation_Jan_2020.pdf

Using Accountability Results to Guide Improvement at https://edsight.ct.gov/relatedreports/Using_Accountability_Results_to_Guide_Improvement.pdf

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Regional School District 15

Narratives

School District Improvement Plans and Parental Outreach Activities

The Superintendent has, in collaboration with the Board of Education, has developed and continued to implement four theories of action. The theories are the focus for the work at the district, department, school, and classroom levels, are the basis for the improvement efforts and professional learning for staff, and are the foundation for curriculum revision and development. These theories help the guide the work to ensure success for all students.

Region 15 has an SRBI (RTI) process where individual plans are developed and student growth is closely monitored. Support is increased in increments for students who require it. This process assures student success without unneeded special education identification. For those students who require special education services, the Region provides a full range of programs. A focus of the programs at every level has been the integration whenever possible, of special education students into the mainstream programs.

The Region has 2 full time social workers to assist in social emotional wellness and in school attendance. These positions are another resource and support for parents. The school social workers received training about truancy prevention from the CSDE and have developed a truancy and resource process for students. Currently, any student who is struggling to get to school or join on-line classes will be referred to the school social workers for a follow up.

Parents are actively involved in the education of their students. Examples of involvement include attending open house, parent-teacher conferences, and parent workshops provided throughout the school year. Workshops have been provided for all parents to access in the areas of social emotional learning and trauma. Parents of children with disabilities have been engaging in activities regarding transitions between school buildings and college and beyond. "How to" videos have been created for parents to access when working with their children during the COVID closures and/or remote learning focusing on technology support for the curriculum.

School and Region news is distributed electronically through School Messenger, school-based newsletters, revised district and school websites, social media, and for the 2020-2021 school year, weekly emails to families and staff. Starting in the spring of 2019-2020 and extending through the 2020-2021 school year, all teachers maintained a web-presence, listing short and long term assignment and activities either on the Region15 webpage or in Google Classroom. Social media is also used by administration and teachers as a way to share information about the schools and activities that offer within the schools and throughout the Region.

The Parent Teacher Organizations (PTOs) are active and involved in each school. A representative from each school's PTO meets with the Superintendent on a monthly basis. The PTOs at each school provide regular input to the administration on programming and provide a variety of services to the schools and students. The PTOs help sustain a positive culture by sponsoring school-based activities such as "Movie Night."

Efforts to Reduce Racial, Ethnic and Economic Isolation

The Region has continued its focus on welcoming and inclusive schools and renamed the committee that was established in 2017 to the Equity & Inclusion Council. This Council includes parents, teachers, administrators, high school students, and other community members. The Council's goals include building an awareness in students, staff, and the community about life-long respect and compassion for themselves and other human being regardless of race, ethnic origin, gender, social class, disability, religion, appearance or sexual orientation. Since its inception in 2017, the Council's membership has risen to close to 100 participants. Starting in the spring of 2020 and continuing through the end of the 2020-2021 school year, the Council met virtually, and the work and activities continued. The community members of the Council have also provided programming for the towns. One example of the work was the virtual panel of STEM (Science, Technology, Engineering, Mathematics) experts who answered questions and shared information about their jobs, education, and interests in these areas.

The staff is committed to providing opportunities to assist in the Council's goals. The efforts include a variety of classroom, grade level, school-wide, and district-wide programs, events, and activities, the revision of curriculum to ensure that students have both "windows and mirrors," training on bias for paraprofessionals and new teachers, ADL Ally training for middle school students, etc. Cultural arts programs and assemblies throughout the year provide opportunities for students to experience different culture, celebrations, music, and activities. This school year, a Teacher in Residence for Cultural Competency & Diversity (TIR) was established. The TIR assists teachers in Grades PK-12 in developing/delivering lessons that are both "mirrors and windows" using the Region's curriculum. The TIR also provides professional development to staff in the areas of equity & inclusion.

Each of the schools in Region 15 has a leadership group focused on programs and fundraisers to support community and humanitarian causes such as contributions to local food banks, clothing drives to support families in need, and support to charitable organizations.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Regional School District 15

Equitable Allocation of Resources among District Schools

The Region 15 Board of Education has a strong commitment to providing equitable allocation of resources among the schools in the district. Building level principals, district-wide administrators, and central office staff work collaborative to develop a budget that addresses the needs of each school and supports the theories of action of the Region. The Board of Education allocates financial resources based upon needs identified on an annual basis. Some allocations such as those for technology and for facilities are based on long-term planning to ensure that the Region is providing funds for the greatest needs.

Staffing is closely monitored to ensure equitable programming at each of the schools. Class sizes are based on planning numbers that have been recommended by the school system.

During the budget process, the Superintendent, the Board of Education members, and administrators have community meetings to discuss funding needs and to listen to the public's feedback.